

Experiment Log — Sprint 2: Wizard-of-Oz MVP

Venture: Parlance
Date range: May 22 – June 10, 2026
Experiment type: Solution validation (fake door / manual MVP)
Submitted by: Team Parlance

Hypothesis

Users who complete one AI conversation rehearsal session will return for a second session within 7 days without prompting.

Experiment Design

Element	Detail
MVP form	Shared Claude Project + Google Form feedback (no custom app yet)
Scenarios offered	Job interview (behavioral), presentation Q&A
Participants	12 users from Sprint 1 warm leads
Flow	Pre-confidence Google Form (4 Likert items) → 10-min Claude conversation → post-confidence form
Success metric	≥50% return for session 2 within 7 days
Failure metric	<30% return → hypothesis rejected

Results

Metric	Result
Session 1 completions	12/12 (100%)
Session 2 within 7 days	7/12 (58%) 
Session 3+ within 14 days	4/12 (33%)
Avg session duration	11.4 minutes
Avg pre→post confidence (overall)	+1.8 points (1–10 scale)

Session 1 vs Session 2 confidence delta

Measure	Session 1 avg Δ	Session 2 avg Δ
Overall confidence	+1.8	+2.4
Verbal organization	+1.6	+2.1
Anxiety (lower = better)	-1.2	-1.9
Preparedness	+2.0	+2.6

Dropout reasons (n=5 did not return)

- 2 — "Forgot / busy with finals"
- 1 — "Felt awkward talking to AI"
- 1 — "Wanted video/audio, not text"
- 1 — No response

AI Leverage

- Claude Project configured with scenario system prompts (same prompts now in Parlance app)
- GPT-4 used to generate 15 follow-up question variants; A/B tested "warm coach" vs "tough interviewer" tone
- **Finding:** Tough interviewer tone had 67% session 2 return vs 50% for warm coach → adopted in MVP

Key learning

Users **will** return to AI rehearsal if the first session feels realistic and they see a confidence bump.

The 58% return rate exceeds our 50% threshold. Awkwardness was lower than feared (1/12). Text-only was acceptable for MVP but audio is top feature request (9/12).

Pivot

- **Add:** Pre/post confidence surveys as core product loop (now in app)
- **Defer:** Audio mode, custom scenarios
- **Build:** Custom web app (this repo) to replace manual Claude links for Sprint 3

Risk assumptions tested

Assumption	Result
Users will practice with AI repeatedly	✅ 58% week-1 return
Transfer to real life occurs	⚠️ Early signal: 5 users reported "felt more prepared" in real interview within 2 weeks — anecdotal, needs Sprint 3

Rubric self-assessment

Pillar	Score	Notes
Learning velocity	5	WoZ in 2 weeks; clear build decision
Problem significance	4	Return rate confirms problem-solution fit emerging
AI integration	5	AI was the product AND the analysis tool
Venture progress	4	WoZ → decision to build
Responsible impact	4	Disclosed as beta; no data retention on Claude free tier
Coachability	5	Pivoted coaching tone based on A/B data

Next experiment

Sprint 3 — 10 users, 2-week access to Parlance web app. Measure session frequency, WoW retention, confidence change.